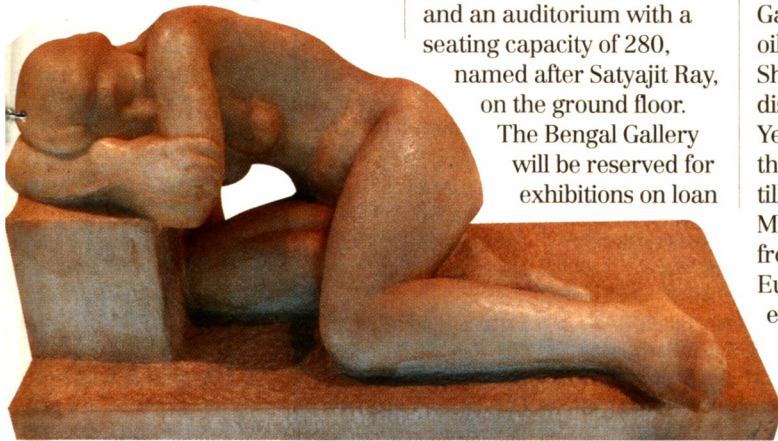


art Culture Club

KOLKATA Another chapter has been added in the cultural landscape of the City of Joy with the inauguration of Rabindranath Tagore Centre. The first of its kind to be run by the Indian Council of Cultural Relations (ICCR), the centre will act as **PRISTINE BEAUTY: A work of art on display the Centre**



a cultural hub for interaction not only within India, but also within South-East Asia. A copy of Ramkinkar's famous bronze bust of Nobel laureate Tagore greets visitors at the entrance to the centre's imposing four-storey building which was designed originally by Charles Correa and later revised and completed by Dulal Mukherjee. The centre has multiple art galleries on its three floors and an auditorium with a seating capacity of 280, named after Satyajit Ray, on the ground floor. The Bengal Gallery will be reserved for exhibitions on loan

from the state Government, while the Abanindranath Tagore Gallery, Nandalal Bose Gallery, Jamini Roy Gallery and the Ramkinkar Baij Sculpture Court will be available for various art exhibitions. Few noticeable works of art include the rare pencil portrait of the bard by Chintamani Kar done in 1940 at the Bengal Gallery, a rare Somenath Hore bronze sculpture at the open air Ramkinkar Gallery, and *Kabul War*, an oil painting by Abdul Shakoor Khasrawe, on display at the Jaisalmer Yellow Exhibition. Among the exhibitions that are on till June 15 include Bengal Masters, paintings by artists from SAARC nations and the European Connection, an exhibition of paintings from the Jean-Baptiste Gentil Collection—Lost Palaces of Delhi.

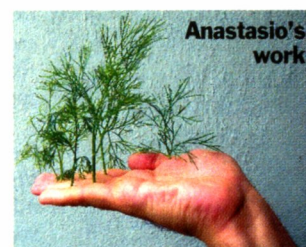
by Elora Sen

recommendations Dance and Clay

BANGALORE Through a photo exhibition titled Cosmic Dance of Siva, on display at the Alliance Française from June 10 to 14, Sharada Srinivasan, a scientist and a Bharatnatyam dancer, illustrates how in an era preceding the Italian Renaissance, the celebrated 10th century Nataraja integrated art, science, poetry and dance. A lecture-cum-dance performance by Srinivasan on June 14 is touted to be the high point of the show.

Elsewhere, at GallerySKE, a series of images and sculptures created with materials and artefacts from daily life,

Under the Same Roof mark the debut of artist Andrea Anastasio. The show refers to a space where "the body and mind, the sensorial and intellectual, are both actively at play". Works on display



like the Gold Fish, where a fishing net made of gold polyester fabric, is used to construct a new space in which the audience is encouraged to "engage and transfer an engendered poet to his everyday dimension". On till July 9.

HYDERABAD Shankarananda Kalakshetra will present two shows choreographed by Ananda Shankar—*Sri Rama Namam-Entha Ruchi Ra* on June 10 and *Dancing Tales... Panchatantra* on June 13 at Ravindra Bharati.

music reviews Winning Hit

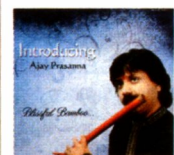


Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 175

**THODA
PYAAR
THODA
MAGIC**

Shankar-Ehsaan-Loy's latest offering

is true to the character of their compositions—simply melodious. Sung by Shankar in his inimitable style, the first one in the album, *Pyaar ke liye*, is a sure winner, but nevertheless others like the qawwali-based song, *Nihaal ho gayi*, and *Bulbula*, a peppy number belted out by Sunidhi Chauhan, have it all—good voice complimented with perfect orchestration. An impressive number *Lazy lamhe* by newcomer Anusha Mani uses percussion instruments innovatively while the last track, *Beetey kal se hum*, is a song which takes you on a voyage of life's realities. If you love remixes, there are two songs—*Nihaal ho gayi* and *Lazy lamhe*—remixed by DJ Aqeel in the album.



YRF Music
Rs 149

**BLISSFUL
BAMBOO**

Ajay Prasanna comes from a family of classical musicians

who received training from his father Pandit Bholanath Prasanna of the Benaras gharana, the guru of Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia. His album has some rare ragas—Malay Maruttam, Bhavani Bhairav, Rageshwari Kauns, Saraswati and Shankh Dhvani. Relating an anecdote about Shankh Dhvani, Prasanna says, "In 1952, my father had a dream. He saw Lord Shiva blowing a *shankh*, playing his *damru* and dancing. This gave birth to a new raga. It was dedicated to Shiva and called Shankh Dhvani."

by S. Sahaya Ranjit